

Oral Medications - ADA

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What Are My Options for Type 2 Diabetes Medications? | ADA

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Health & Wellness Oral & Injectable Medications for Type 2 Diabetes

People with type 2 diabetes can use various medications other than insulin to help manage their diabetes effectively. However, individuals with type 1 diabetes must rely on insulin for blood glucose (blood sugar) management. Many type 2 diabetes medications, including oral and injectable options, work in different ways to regulate blood glucose levels. Managing type 2 diabetes involves a comprehensive approach that includes meal planning, regular physical activity, and the right diabetes medications. By combining these three strategies, individuals can effectively regulate their blood glucose levels. Oral medications for type 2 diabetes are commonly prescribed as part of a treatment plan to help maintain stable blood glucose levels. Diabetes is a progressive disease and medications sometimes stop working as well over time. When this happens adjustments to your medication or combination therapy can help, which may include adding insulin to your treatment plan. This doesn't mean you're doing something wrong. Even if diabetes other medications do bring your blood glucose levels near the normal range, you may need to take insulin if you have a severe infection or need surgery. Other medications may not be able to keep your blood glucose levels in your target range during these stressful times that affect your blood glucose. Common Type 2 Diabetes Medications There are different types, or classes, of medications that work in different ways to lower blood glucose levels. Some options are taken by mouth and others are injected. Some of the commonly used classes of non-insulin medications include: Metformin Dipeptidyl peptidase 4 (DPP-4) inhibitors Glucagon-like peptide 1 (GLP-1) and dual glucose-dependent insulinotropic polypeptide (GIP) and GLP-1 receptor agonists Sodium-glucose cotransporter 2 (SGLT2) inhibitors Sulfonylureas Thiazolidinediones (TZDs) Metformin Metformin (Glucophage) is classified as a biguanide medication and is the only available medication in this class

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